

Checking in

"Checking in" on a social media site lets a person tell others where they are and what they're doing at that moment. But there are risks, as doing so reveals a person's location to a potentially enormous number of people.

A "check-in" could make burglars aware that a home is empty or allow a stalker to work out a person's routine. To reduce the risks, privacy settings should be changed, so that only close connections can see where a person has checked in, and the home address should never be revealed.



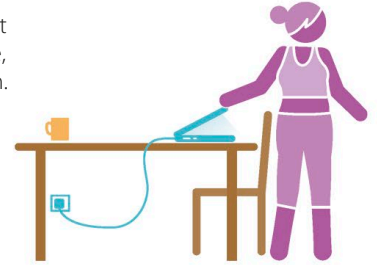
△ Pros and cons

Checking in at the premises of a business—a restaurant or shop, for example—might also mean that a person receives a discount or can leave a review. But businesses may not always be transparent about what information they're collecting or how they will use it in the future.

Taking a break

Maintaining a profile and keeping up with what everyone else is doing can take up a lot of time, so it's worth taking a break every now and then. If a teen wants to stop using social media, they have three options (always check the terms and conditions of the particular site first):

- Not logging in to the site will keep their account active, and they will continue to receive notifications.
- Deactivating the account will remove the user's profile from the site, but their information, including photographs and comments, is still there if they choose to reactivate it.
- Shutting down the account permanently means all information is deleted and they will no longer receive notifications.



TEEN HINTS

Comparing profiles

Social media allows people to connect and communicate with each other, but seeing the lives of friends and celebrities, and how much attention they receive online, can lead some to make comparisons. These comparisons may cause teens to feel sad, lonely, or envious of other people, and as if they are missing out. Remember that people on social media present an edited version of themselves, which only reveals the best bits of their lives, and that they have times when they feel bored, lonely, or grumpy, too.



Social media and advertising

Most social media platforms are free, and so they earn money from placing ads on their sites. Advertising on social media is often tailored to the user, based on what they have revealed on the platform about their preferences and interests.

User inputs information

A user on social media shares information on their personal profile—such as their interests, photographs, and opinions.



Advertisers pay to advertise

Advertisers are drawn by the numbers of people who use the platform, and pay to advertise to them on it.



Direct ads appear

The ads target the users—for example, if a teen expresses a preference for a particular band, they will see ads for the band's concerts and merchandise.

